

HAMZA BENMESSAOUD

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Master's candidate in Market Finance at HEC Montréal (GPA 3.85/4.3), with a dual background in finance and applied economics. I completed two consecutive internships at National Bank of Canada, giving me a concrete understanding of its operations, culture, and teams. I am currently Economic Analyst at the Fonds BNI-HEC Montréal, where I write macro investment theses supporting strategic and tactical allocation decisions. My profile combines analytical rigor developed through valuation projects, portfolio management, and applied econometrics, with a proven ability to deliver results in demanding environments.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Market Finance | HEC Montréal

Expected Dec. 2027

- GPA 3.85/4.3 | Completed coursework: Derivatives Valuation, Econometric Methods in Finance, Empirical Finance
- Current coursework: Corporate Finance (FINA 60222 — mergers & acquisitions, leveraged valuation, capital structure, governance), Capital Markets Theory

B.B.A. — Finance & Applied Economics | HEC Montréal

2025

- Econometrics, Financial Diagnostics, Portfolio Management, Options and Futures | Exchange: Tecnológico de Monterrey (Mobility Scholarship)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Economic Analyst – Asset Allocation, Fonds BNI-HEC Montréal

Fall 2026 – Present

- Write macro investment theses supporting strategic (80%) and tactical (20%) allocation decisions for a multi-asset portfolio (\$8M+ AUM)

Teaching Assistant — Options and Futures (FINA 20210) | HEC Montréal

Fall 2026

- Support students and grade assignments and exams for approximately 300 students across 6 sections, under the supervision of Prof. Aboul-Enein

NBFWM Internship Program — Wealth Management | National Bank of Canada

Summer 2025 – May 2026

- Led the rollout of a new technical training platform across the network, reaching 850 investment advisors — an estimated 10% reduction in onboarding time versus the previous format

Business Analyst Intern, Continuous Optimization | National Bank of Canada

Summer 2024 – May 2025

- Modelled profitability for a portfolio of 30,000+ accounts (Excel VBA); built performance dashboards used by senior management — 15% efficiency gain
- Presented strategic recommendations to leadership — direct impact on 500 branches and 2,000 employees

PROJECTS, COMPETITIONS & DISTINCTIONS

BNC Asset Management Challenge — Emerging Markets Allocation & Governance

- Responsible for emerging-markets allocation and team governance, weekly macro meetings — 3% alpha generated as a team, risk governance (VaR, tracking error)

BlackBerry (Sell) & Dollarama (Buy, 2nd Place) Stock Pitches | HEC Montréal

- Three-phase DCF, CAPM, sensitivity analysis; sell recommendation defended before an expert panel. Dollarama buy thesis with ESG integration — 2nd place, IRQ Club & Finance Montréal panel

Econometric Study — Canada as a Petro-Currency: Macro Determinants of CAD/USD | HEC Montréal

- OLS model (HC1 robust errors, 179 monthly observations) — adjusted R^2 of 63.9%; petro-currency status empirically confirmed

Currency Factor Model via PCA | HEC Montréal

- 3 latent factors extracted via PCA across 5 currencies, explaining 86.9% of variance; Dollar factor and Global Financial Cycle factor identified and validated

CERTIFICATIONS, INVOLVEMENT & INTERESTS

- Certification:** Bloomberg Market Concepts (BMC)
- Analysis & Valuation:** DCF, comparables, macro analysis, portfolio management, quantitative analysis
- Personal Macro Tracking:** Weekly macroeconomic review (IS-LM framework)
- Tools:** Python, R, Bloomberg Terminal
- Leadership:** Cohort President, Visibility Officer — ASGC, HEC Ambassador (MaCarrière) | CHU Sainte-Justine Fundraising Campaign: \$38,000 raised
- Volunteering & Sports:** Fondation Marie-Vincent, Mission Bon Accueil, Moisson Rive-Sud | Triathlon, Hyrox, Spartan Race